5 June 1952

MEMORANDUM FOR: DIRECTOR OF INTELLIGENCE, DCS/O

SUBJECT: Declassifying Photographs of Unidentified Flying Objects

1. This office understands that two photographs of unidentified flying objects were taken by a Mr. [redacted] of Phoenix, Arizona, and that these photographs were turned over to Fourth Air Force Intelligence in July of 1947.

This office has been contacted by Mr. [redacted] who is requesting return of his original negatives.

3. The two photographs were copied by the Photographic Records and Services Division of the Air Adjutant General's Office at this headquarters and are in a confidential file of Unidentified Missiles as A-34921AC and 34921AC.

4. This office requests that consideration be given to declassifying these two photographs and that the original negatives be sent to this office for return to Mr. [redacted]

/s/
ARNO H. LUEHMAN
Colonel, USAF
Deputy Director of
Public Information

Copied 16 Jun/llg

UNITED STATES AIR FORCE
THE INSPECTOR GENERAL
OFFICE OF SPECIAL INVESTIGATIONS

REPORT OF INVESTIGATION

FILE NO.	DATE
24-23	17 August 1949

REPORT MADE BY
LYNN C. ALDRICH

TITLE
[redacted]
UNCLASSIFIED

REPORT MADE AT
DO #17, Kirtland AFB

PERIOD
7,20,21 June, 15,18,19 July 49

OFFICE OF ORIGIN
DO #5, Wright-Patterson AFB

STATUS
RUC

CHARACTER
SPECIAL INQUIRY

REFERENCE
Rpt of Invest by SA THOMAS F. DOYLE, Jr., DO 5, Wright-Patterson AFB, file #5d-24-27, dtd 19 May 49.

SYNOPSIS

Better Business Bureau, Chamber of Commerce and Arizona Corporation Commission checked with negative results. Credit Bureau record attached as Exhibit A. City directories and telephone directory checked. Mr and Mrs. [redacted] neighbors, stated SUBJECT is excellent neighbor, caused no trouble, is emotionally high strung, egotistical and a genius in fundamentals of radio and electronics. SUBJECT is musician by trade, has no steady job and devotes all of his time to research. SUBJECT wrote scientific article for nationally known magazine and received honorary Doctor of Science degree from [redacted] University for this article. [redacted] was name devised by SUBJECT to impress people with his importance. SUBJECT conducts no business under this name; enjoys a good reputation in community and is a loyal American. Mrs [redacted] another neighbor, disclosed SUBJECT is a good neighbor and has caused no trouble in community. SUBJECT is musician by trade, but devotes his time to research in electronics, astronomy, radio and photography. SUBJECT wrote thesis on astronomy and was offered an honorary scholarship by big University in east (name unknown). SUBJECT has no close friends or associates, and informant knew no information concerning the origin of [redacted] Files of T-1 reflected the report of interview and observations of Agent. Local agencies checked with negative results.

DISTRIBUTION

CG AMC(MCIAXS) 2
(Action Cy) (1 Incl)
CSI Eq (1 Incl) 2
DO #5, Wright-Patterson AFB (1 Incl) 2
File (1 Incl) 2

ACTION COPY FORWARDED TO

Commanding General
Air Materiel Command
Wright-Patterson AFB, Ohio
ATTN: MCIAXS

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DECLASSIFIED AFTER 12 YEARS.
DOD DIR. 5200.10

APPROVED

DOYLE REES
Lt Col, USAF
District Commander.

FILE STAMP

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AFHQ FORM 16 JAN 49 0-208 Replaces AFCSI Form 4, 23 Jul

16—57744-1 U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE

photograph includes the tops of some trees and a telephone pole. Mr. [redacted] stated that he developed the negatives himself. He still had the negative of the first photograph (Exhibit III), but he could not find the negative for the second photograph.

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George Fugate, Jr., Special Agent, CIC-ADC-4AF

[redacted]

~~CONFIDENTIAL~~

[redacted]

Investigation of "Flying Discs"
2 September 1947

UNCLASSIFIED

MEMORANDUM FOR THE OFFICER IN CHARGE

On 29 August 1947 in the presence of S/A Brower (FBI Office, Phoenix, Arizona) [redacted] was interviewed at his residence at [redacted] Phoenix, Arizona, in connection with investigation of the "Flying Discs". Mr. Rhodes stated that on the afternoon of 7 July 1947 immediately following a local thunderstorm, at about 1500 hrs., he was walking from his home toward his workshop (located approximately 100ft. directly back of the house) when he heard a noise in the east which sounded to him very much like the approach of a jet airplane, possibly a P-80. He stopped and looked to the east but saw nothing for several seconds. A few seconds later, however, an object appeared from the north-east. The object seemed elliptical in shape with a diameter of 20-30ft. At first sight, it appeared to be at about 5000ft., traveling about 400 to 600MPH. Its color was grey, which made it blend into the clouds and difficult to see at a distance. As soon as it appeared in the north-east, the object spiraled downward reaching a level of about 2000ft. at the end of its second spiral, and then started upward into the west at an angle of 45 degrees, disappearing into the cumulus clouds which appeared to be at about 5000ft. at that time. The object was visible from the time of its appearance in the north-east to its disappearance into the west about 60 seconds. In spite of the fact that a noise was heard prior to the appearance of the object, while in view, it produced no audible sound. The tail of the object had two points on the outside area, visible as it made its two left-to-right circles, which had an approximate radius of 1/4 to 1/2 miles. The object had what looked like a cockpit canopy in the center extending toward the back and under the object. The cockpit did not protrude from the surface but was clearly visible with the naked eye. The object was not revolving on its own axis. It had no discernible landing gears nor propellers. It appeared to have an excellent air foil (tapered from wing tip to wing tip). Mr. [redacted] stated that it is possible that he did not hear the object while it was in sight because of the rustling of tree leaves set up by a wind velocity of 10-15MPH. He also stated that the first sight of the object caused him to think it might be the Navy's new Flapjack plane illustrated on the cover of the May 1947 issue of "Mechanix Illustrated". He later altered his opinion because the object appeared to have no landing gears and no propellers, and the Navy ship is illustrated as having both. [redacted] stated that immediately after the object had started into its first spiral he ran to get his camera, which he kept loaded and set at all times for the purpose of taking candid action shots of his family and which he kept right inside the door of the workshop. By the time he returned with it, the object had completed one circle and had started on its second. At the same time he called to his wife who was in the house, but by the time she arrived in the back yard the object had disappeared. [redacted] stated that he managed to take one photograph of the object while it was at its lowest point (about 2000ft.) (Exhibit I) and another just as it turned out of its second spiral and started upward. (Exhibit II). The second

George Fugate, Jr., Special Agent, CIC-ADC-4AF

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[redacted]

#1

AF HQ-33 (20 May 44)

HEADQUARTERS UNITED STATES AIR FORCE

ROUTING AND RECORD SHEET

TALLY NO.	
FILE NO.	

SUBJECT: Negatives of UFO's Taken By [redacted] of Phoenix, Arizona in 1947

TO: Air Technical Intelligence Center
ATTN: Capt Hardin

DATE 19 Jan 54

COMMENT NO. 1

FROM: Directorate of Intelligence, DCS/O

AFOIN-X/Lt Col Smith/tjc/71092

These negatives and explaining letter were brought to this office for final disposition, therefore, we are forwarding to you.

W. K. SMITH
Lt Colonel, USAF

2 Incls
1. Ltr to PIO dtd 14 Aug 52 fr Capt Philip Hiaring, PIO
2. Negatives a/s

U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE : 1951—O-972582 16—54288-1

[redacted]

UNCLASSIFIED

UNIDENTIFIABLE OBJECTS,
WILLIAMS FIELD, CHANDLER,
ARIZONA.

14 July 1947

MEMORANDUM FOR THE OFFICER IN CHARGE:

On 8 July 1947, this Agent obtained pictures of unidentifiable objects, (Exhibits 1 and 2) from the managing editor of the Arizona Republic newspaper. The pictures were taken by Mr. [redacted], Phoenix, Arizona, at sunset, on 7 July 1947. The Subject objects flew at unconceivable speeds, making three circles in the vicinity of Mr. [redacted] home. The pictures were taken with a box camera, size 620. The photograph (Exhibit 1) was taken as the object passed in front of Mr. [redacted] and Exhibit 2 as the object turned towards Mr. [redacted] The height of the object was estimated at 1000 feet.

AGENT'S NOTES: See Exhibits 1 and 2, photographs of unidentifiable objects, enlarged approximately 20 times. No further reports have been received by this office of objects seen by military personnel.

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Lynn. C. Aldrich, Special Agent, EIC - AAF, FDTRC

UNCLASSIFIED

[redacted]

c o p y

#1

[redacted]

CHECK-LIST - UNIDENTIFIED FLYING OBJECTS

Incident # 40

UNCLASSIFIED

1. Date 7 July 1947
2. Time 1600
3. Location Phoenix, Arizona
4. Name of observer [redacted]
5. Occupation of observor N/S
6. Address of observor [redacted] Arizona
7. Place of observation 37° 27' N 112° 3' W
8. Number of objects 1
9. Distance of object from observer N/S
10. Time in sight N/S
11. Altitude 2,000 ft to 5,000 ft
12. Speed 400-600 MPH
13. Direction of flight ~~X~~ NE to West
14. Tactics Spiraled down from 5000' to 2000 ft and then ascended at 45° angle
15. Sound Noise like jet on approach - no sound heard while in view
16. Size 20-30 ft
17. Color grey
18. Shape elliptical
19. Odor detected N/S
20. Apparent construction N/S
21. Exhaust trails N/S
22. Weather conditions Cumulus clouds
23. Effect on clouds N/S
24. Sketches or photographs Photos (2)
25. Manner of disappearance N/S
26. Remarks: (Over)

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UNCLASSIFIED

[redacted]

97

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Object appeared elliptical in shape and had a diameter of 20-30 feet. When first seen it was at about 5,000 ft and traveling from 400 to 600 MPH. Its grey color rendered it difficult to perceive at a distance as it blended with the clouds. Although a jet-like noise was heard prior to the object's appearance no audible sound was produced while it remained in view. The tail of the object had two points on the outside area, visible as it made its two left-to-right circles which had an approximate radius of 1/4 to 1/2 miles. The object had what appeared to be a cockpit canopy in the center which extended toward the back and beneath the object. The "cockpit" did not protrude from the surface but was clearly visible with the naked eye. The object did not revolve on its own axis. It had no discernible landing gears nor propellers. It appeared to have an excellent air foil (tapered from wing tip to wing tip). Mr. [redacted] thought that the 10-15 MPH wind velocity which caused a rustling of tree leaves might have made it impossible for him to hear any noise connected with the object. He also stated that he thought the object was the Navy's new "Flapjack Plane" but altered his opinion since the object seemed to have no landing gears and no propellers. (The Navy ship is illustrated as having both). [redacted] managed to take one photograph of the object at its lowest point (about 2000 ft) and another as it turned out of its second spiral and started upward.

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Incident No. 40 — 7 July 1947, 1600 hours, Phoenix, Airzona.
One observer witnessed an elliptical, flat, gray object, measuring 20-30 ft across, flying 400-600 MPH, spiraling downward to 2000 ft from 5000 ft, then ascending at a 45° angle into an overcast. Observer ran into a garage where he obtained a Kodak Brownie 120 box camera, and snapped two pictures; one negative, and a print of the other, are contained in project files. The negative displays a small apparently flat object rounded on one end, and pointed on the other. The object appears to have a hole in the center. The image is in stark contrast with the background of clouds. From the print, the object appears to be jet black with sharp outlines. Four expert photographers concur in the opinion that the image is of true photographic nature. However, they disagree with each other as to the possibility of filming such an occurrence under the conditions described. Considering the object was grey as described, and at a distance of 2000 feet, it seems unlikely that it would appear pure black on the print. In subsequent correspondence to the reporter of this incident, the observer refers to himself as [redacted] the letterhead of which lists photography among one of its specialities. Yet, the negative was carelessly cut and faultily developed. It is covered with streaks and over a period of six months, has faded very noticeably. An OSI agent discovered that a letter by this observer was published by Amazing Stories magazine early this year. In this letter he stated that he had been interviewed by two Federal agents, had given them pictures of "flying discs" and that the pictures had not been returned. He requested the advice of the magazine as to how to proceed to sue the Government. This individual is aware of the whereabouts of these pictures, but has never requested their return. There are other undesirable aspects to this case. The observer's character and business affiliations are presently under investigation, the results of which are not yet known. Dr. Irving Langmuir studied subject photographs, and after learning of the prior passage of a thunderstorm, discounted the photographed object as being merely paper swept up by the winds.

AIC Opinion: In view of the apparent character of the witness, the conclusion by Dr. Langmuir seems entirely probable.

TO MCIAXS FROM MCIS DATE 21 Mar 49 COMMENT NO. 3. (Con't)

[redacted]

of a soft ball batter in which a shadow of the ball and bat on the ground are seperated by approximately 4 inches and the image of the bat and ball are in contact. In the case of the Rotary type shutter another type of distortion is introduced due to the wiping action of the shutter aperture. This distortion makes it quite probable for the elongration of the tail as shown on one of the exhibits of the attached report. The camera which took this photograph being a box camera had a rotary wiping type shutter.

b. In clarification of comment in sub-paragraph b, paragraph 2, Comment No. 2, the following explanation is given: In the photographic processes it is quite possible to increase the contrast of the finished product over the original visual contrast of the original object by increasing developing time of the negative and printing that negative on a hard or contrasty paper. As stated in the report by Mr. [redacted] the object being grey blended with the grey overcast cloud. It also appears that the underneath side of the aircraft or object in question not being lighted by the sun is, therefore, in shadow and would not reflect as much light to impress it's image on the film as would the clouds which are diffusing the light from the sun. The photographic contrast is obtained through the processing means outlined above.

Guy S. Rodwell

2 Incls.
N/C

for LEWIS C. GUST
Chief, Science Survey Office
Intelligence Department

GSK/cc
26149

[redacted]

(DO NOT WRITE BELOW THIS LINE)

[redacted]

[redacted]

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altitude and azimuth Mr. [redacted] camera was pointed at the time of his two exposures and the approximate time interval between exposures. Physical data like these are absolutely essential if we are to get anywhere in any basic physical explanation of these incidents.

There remains the strong possibility that the entire incident is spurious, and the invention of an excitable mind. This strengthens the need for reinvestigation; if spurious, this fact should be highlighted and even publicized, to quench enthusiasm for the irresponsible reporting of "saucers" and like objects.

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[redacted]

[redacted]

[redacted]

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Incident #40 — Phoenix, Arizona — 7 July 1947

No astronomical explanation seems possible for the unusual object cited in this incident.

This case is especially important because of the photographic evidence and because of the similarity of these photographs to the drawings by [redacted] (incident #17). The two incidents are separated by slightly more than two weeks, and, of course, they occurred in different localities. It is, however, perhaps more than coincidence that these two best-attested, entirely independent cases should agree so closely concerning the shape of the object and its maneuverability.

The present investigator would like to suggest that this incident, #40, being one of the most crucial in the history of these objects, be reopened for investigation. The actual camera used by Mr. [redacted] should be examined, and the original negatives preserved. Since, from the size of the image on the photograph, we can have an accurate estimate of the angle subtended by the object, this in connection with what appears to be a fairly reliable estimate of the distance, can give us an estimate of the forces and accelerations involved in the trajectory described by Mr. [redacted]. (It is unfortunate that a competent investigator was not dispatched at once to "reenact the crime" with Mr. [redacted] and to obtain sketches of the trajectory, etc., before details faded from his memory.) It would be important to know at what

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[redacted]

Form No. 10-3
(19 Mar 45)

ROUTING AND RECORD SHEET

[redacted]

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AIR MATERIEL COMMAND

Use this form for inter-office correspondence within headquarters.

Use authorized office symbols to designate addressor and addressee.

Place initials of dictator and typist, telephone number and location to right of signature.

Use entire width of sheet, both sides.

Number all comments consecutively.

Separate comments by horizontal lines across page.

SUBJECT: Identification of Subject Matter (as per sample)

TO: MCIA FROM: MCIT DATE: 19 Feb 43 COMMENT NO. 1

1. Reference is made to the films taken by Mr. [redacted] (Incident #40) which were forwarded for examination. The following data were derived from a study of the specimen:

a. It is concluded that the image is of true photographic nature, and is not due to imperfections in the emulsion, or lack of development in the section in question. The image exhibits a "tail" indicating the proper type of distortion due to the type of shutter used, the speed of the object and the fixed speed of the shutter. This trailing off conforms to the general information given in the report.

b. The report states the object was seen at approximately 2000 feet at the time of exposure. The observer also reports being able to see clearly a canopy or enclosure. The visual acuity of an average person would allow for this perception, but certainly not much further as the subject had low visual contrast, being gray against a gray sky. If we can establish the distance from camera to subject, we will have quantity #1. The report states that a 620 camera was used, indicating several possibilities, since the 620 is nomenclature for the spooling and width of the film we may have negatives $2\frac{1}{4}$ x $2\frac{1}{4}$", $2\frac{1}{4}$ x $3\frac{1}{4}$" and $2\frac{1}{4}$ x $4\frac{1}{4}$". The sample submitted had been cut and it was not possible to establish the exact frame size. The $2\frac{1}{4}$ x $2\frac{1}{4}$" size was ruled out, leaving $2\frac{1}{4}$ x $3\frac{1}{4}$" and $2\frac{1}{4}$ x $4\frac{1}{4}$". If it were the former, then the focal length of the lens would be 4", and using 2000 feet as the approximate subject distance and the image size at 7/64", we have an approximate size of 44 feet as the diagonal of the object. Now if we choose the latter value of 5" for focal length, we have an approximate value of 55' for the diagonal. Points of measurement are indicated from x to x on Exhibit "A".

c. It should be pointed out, the need for more detail in reports is brought out in this report. A summary would suggest the following points:

(1) Name of camera, type of film used, developer as well as time and temperature, exposure time, focal length of lens and F value used.

(2) If possible, the camera should be aimed to include some ground and horizon as this will help fix the distance from camera to subject by imaging reference points. These reference points can be referred to for evaluation.

1 Incl
Exhibit "A"

Lewis C. Gust
LEWIS C. GUST, Chief
Technical Projects Office
Intelligence Department

LG/amb
23227
Bldg 682

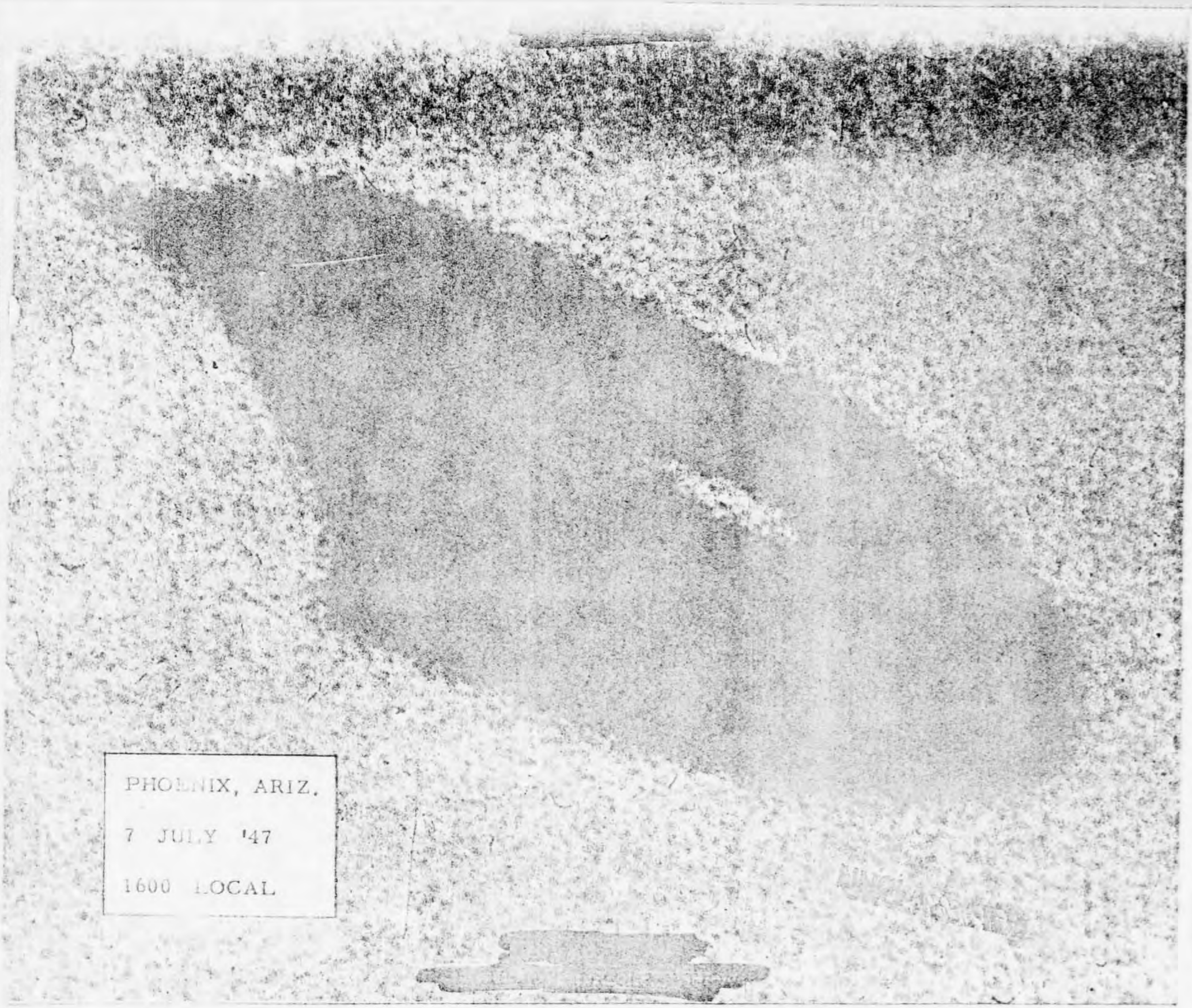
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[redacted]

Incid #40

WP-L-16 JUNE 46 1 Mil

(CONTINUE ON OTHER SIDE)


PHOENIX, ARIZ.
7 JULY '47
1600 LOCAL



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TELECONFERENCE MESSAGE FORM

(See ... tructions on reverse side of ... page)

1. ITEM NO.	2. SECURITY CLASSIFICATION [redacted] CONFIDENTIAL	3. DATE TRANSMITTED 11 June 1952
4. FROM: (Name & Symbol) UNCLASSIFIED Lt E. J. Ruppelt, ATIAA-2c	5. TO: (Name & Symbol) Capt Fournet, AFOIN-2B3	

Security Information. Reference TT 143 dated 10 June 52, CSAF Item #4. ATIC has no negatives of the unidentified object that were taken by Mr. [redacted] in July 47. In addition, there is no information available as to whether or not [redacted] ever sent his negatives to the Air Force or whether he just sent prints. We do have some rather poor quality prints of the object. As you know, we have concluded that these photos were probably not authentic. It seems as if Mr. [redacted] attempted to get on the "picture selling band wagon" and if he can prove he sent the negatives to ATIC or to the Air Force and they were never returned, it may lead to a touchy situation. Will you answer Mr. [redacted] or do you request that we answer? Copy negatives of the prints can be made if you so desire, however, the originals are not here.

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DOD DIR 5200.10

TT-143 CSAF Item 4 SUBJECT NAME	13 June 52 SUSPENSE DATE	E588424 NUMBER
FROM AFOIN-2B3 Fournet	DATE 10 June 52	TYPE TT
	FILE DESIGNATION	

(If more space is ne...

SUMMARY

7. ORIGINATED BY: (N...

Lt E. J. Ruppelt,

9. AUTHORIZED BY:

TO ATIAA-2c Ruppelt	TO	TO	TO	TO
DATE 10 June 52	DATE	DATE	DATE	DATE

REPLIED OR INDORSED TO	FILED (Place)	OTHER ACTION

Air Adjutant General, ATIPA

SECURITY STAMP [redacted] UNCLASSIFIED

ATIC Form ... (1 Nov 51)